

PORTFOLIO WEBSITE

Design Document

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Planning document: project description, personas, user stories, mockups, and visual direction

1. Project Description

This project is a personal portfolio website that represents the last few years of my life and the progress I have made. The main purpose of this website is to show my classmates and potential recruiters who I am, what my skills and interests are, and also share a little about my personal life.

The website is based on three main areas. The first one is a general overview about me, or the short version of who I am. The second one is the long version of my career in the tech world, where I describe my skills and knowledge, what I have learned, the projects I have worked on, and the experience I have gained. Finally, the third one is about my personal life, because not everything is about being behind a computer. On this page, I will share some of my hobbies, a little about my family, and my dog.

This is not just a website with my information; I want it to become a living résumé that represents my journey. As my life, experience, and skills change over time, this website will change with me.

Site Structure

Page	Purpose	Primary Audience
Home	The short version: profile, key skills, experience snapshot, education, projects, and contact.	Recruiters and classmates
Experience & Projects	The long version: professional journey, detailed skills, projects, education, and certifications.	Recruiters and classmates
Beyond the Résumé	A more personal view of Alejandra through hobbies, family, photographs, and interests.	Classmates and visitors

2. User Personas

Persona 1 — Olivia Montes

Computer Science Student

Background: Olivia is a student at Northeastern University enrolled in the MS in Computer Science Align program. Since she comes from a different background, she does not have much experience in the tech industry yet and is starting to explore this new career path.

Goals: Olivia is interested in learning about the different paths her classmates have taken to enter the tech world. She wants to explore their experiences, skills, and projects to discover different career options and identify areas that she might want to explore as part of her own path.

Needs: She needs information that is easy to understand and a clear way to explore Alejandra's professional and academic journey without requiring extensive technical knowledge.

Frustrations: She may feel overwhelmed by information that is too technical, poorly organized, or difficult to navigate.

Persona 2 — Rafa Ordoñez

Recruiter

Background: Rafa is a recruiter looking for candidates for different technology positions. He does not have a highly technical background, but he receives a specific job profile and knows the main skills, technologies, and keywords that a candidate should have.

Goals: Rafa wants to quickly identify whether Alejandra's experience and knowledge match the requirements of a position he needs to fill. If the profile seems like a good match, he wants an easy way to contact her and move her to the next stage of the recruiting process.

Needs: He needs brief, precise, and well-organized information about professional experience, education, technical skills, and projects. The most important information should be available from the homepage without requiring him to navigate through multiple pages. He also needs a clear and easy way to contact Alejandra.

Frustrations: Rafa has only a few minutes to review each candidate, so having to search through different pages to find important information would be frustrating. He may also discard a portfolio if there is no clear way to contact the candidate. Since he may be accessing the website from a company-managed device or network, he would prefer a site that does not depend on external content or services that could be blocked, such as YouTube or images hosted on third-party websites.

3. User Stories

Recruiter — Rafa

- As a recruiter, I want to quickly see Alejandra's main technical skills, so that I can determine whether her profile matches the company's requirements.
- As a recruiter, I want to explore Alejandra's professional experience in more detail, so that I can understand whether she has faced problems or situations similar to the ones we currently have at the company.
- As a recruiter, I want to access Alejandra's certifications, so that I can verify her credentials and the skills she has acquired.

Classmate — Olivia

- As a classmate, I want to understand the path Alejandra has followed in her career, so that I can identify skills, technologies, or experiences that could also be useful in my own career path.
- As a classmate, I want to learn more about Alejandra and see her progress in the course, including the tools she has used and her creative work, so that I can learn from her experience and get to know her better.
- As a classmate reviewing Alejandra's assignment, I want to easily verify that the website meets the requirements of the rubric, so that I can complete the required code review.

Design Implications

User Need	Design Response
Rafa needs to identify skills quickly.	Main skills appear directly on the Home page.
Rafa wants deeper professional context.	Experience & Projects provides the detailed

	version of the résumé.
Rafa wants verifiable credentials.	Certifications include clear credential links when available.
Olivia wants to understand Alejandra's path.	The Home includes a visual career journey.
Olivia wants to know Alejandra beyond technical work.	Beyond the Résumé provides a personal, more visual page.
Both users need simple navigation.	Clear navigation, concise sections, and direct access to Contact.

4. Low-Fidelity Design Mockups

These wireframes define content hierarchy and navigation. Colors, exact spacing, typography sizes, and final imagery will be decided during implementation.

4.1 Home — “The Short Version of Me”

Goal: allow a recruiter to understand the essential profile quickly while giving classmates clear paths to explore.

HEADER / NAVIGATION Alejandra Rivas • Home • Experience • Beyond • Contact
HERO Intro text + circular Japanese-animation-style illustration. Orbit navigation: Skills • Education • Experience • Projects • Journey • Beyond. Hover over the central image reveals “Contact me”; click/tap leads to Contact.
SKILLS Development Cloud / Tools Other Skills
EXPERIENCE + EDUCATION Short experience snapshot + current education + link to full details/certifications.
MY JOURNEY Simple visual timeline showing major stages in Alejandra's professional and academic path.
FEATURED PROJECTS 2–3 project cards with image, short description, technologies, and project link when available.
BEYOND THE RÉSUMÉ Small preview of the personal page with a call to action.
CONTACT Email • LinkedIn • GitHub

4.2 Experience & Projects — “The Long Version”

Goal: provide deeper professional context without overloading the Home page.

HEADER / NAVIGATION
Alejandra Rivas • Home • Experience • Beyond • Contact
PAGE INTRO
Experience & Projects — The longer version of my journey through tech.
PROFESSIONAL JOURNEY
Vertical timeline: role • company • dates • responsibilities • what I learned.
SKILLS
Grouped skill cards: Development • Infrastructure • Cloud / Tools • other relevant areas.
PROJECTS
Expandable collection of academic and personal projects with descriptions and technologies.
EDUCATION + CERTIFICATIONS
Northeastern + previous education + certifications with verification links.
CALL TO ACTION
Contact Me • LinkedIn

4.3 Beyond the Résumé — “The Personal Version”

Goal: show Alejandra outside school and work. This page is planned as the AI-generated page required by the assignment.

HEADER / NAVIGATION
Alejandra Rivas • Home • Experience • Beyond • Contact
PERSONAL HERO
Beyond the Résumé — “Because not everything is about being behind a computer.” Large personal photograph.
A LITTLE ABOUT ME
Short personal introduction.
THINGS I ENJOY
Visual cards for hobbies and interests.
PEOPLE I LOVE
Selected personal content, including family and dog.

MEMORIES / PLACES

Photographs of meaningful places, trips, or moments.

BACK TO THE PROFESSIONAL SIDE

[Link back to Experience & Projects.](#)

5. Visual Direction

Color Palette

Color	Hex	Sample
Navy	#0B1F3A	
Deep Blue	#163D6B	
Steel Blue	#2F6690	
Bright Blue	#3A86C8	
Ice Blue	#DCEAF7	
Off White	#F7F9FC	
Charcoal	#17202A	

Typography

Headings: Montserrat — used for major headings, section titles, navigation, and selected buttons.

Body: A neutral system sans-serif for readability and reliability.

Montserrat is planned to be served locally rather than depending on Google Fonts, helping the portfolio remain visually consistent on networks where external resources may be blocked.

Visual Language

- Dark blue is the primary identity, supported by multiple blue tones and light neutral backgrounds.
- Generous whitespace and concise text will keep the portfolio easy to scan.
- Circles from the hero will be repeated subtly in timeline markers and other small visual details.
- Cards will use lightly rounded corners and restrained shadows.
- The Home uses an illustrated representation of Alejandra; Beyond the Résumé uses real photographs.
- Essential images, CSS, JavaScript, and fonts should be stored locally so the site does not depend on third-party content to render correctly.

Hero Interaction Concept

The Home hero is the main creative component. A circular illustration sits in the center, surrounded by navigation circles for Skills, Education, Experience, Projects, Journey, and Beyond. Selecting an orbit item moves the visitor to the corresponding section. Hovering over the central illustration applies a subtle visual effect and reveals “Contact me,” which links to the Contact section. On touch devices, the design will provide an equivalent interaction without depending on hover.

6. Planned Technical Structure

The site will remain front-end only and will use vanilla HTML5, CSS3, and ES6+ modules. No component library or jQuery is planned.

```
alejandra-portfolio/  
├─ index.html  
├─ experience.html  
├─ beyond.html  
├─ README.md  
├─ LICENSE  
├─ package.json  
├─ css/  
│   └─ styles.css  
├─ js/  
│   ├── main.js  
│   └─ navigation.js  
├─ images/  
│   ├── profile/  
│   ├── projects/  
│   └─ personal/  
└─ fonts/  
    └─ montserrat/
```

Implementation Principles

- Use semantic HTML elements and standard controls.
- Use CSS Grid and/or Flexbox for layout and responsive behavior.
- Use ES6 modules for all JavaScript.
- Keep the Home useful as a short résumé even if the visitor does not open another page.
- Make the orbit navigation responsive; mobile interactions must not depend exclusively on hover.
- Keep resources organized by type and avoid unnecessary external dependencies.
- Use Prettier, the class ESLint configuration, and W3C validation before submission.

Design status: Initial planning complete. Content and visual details may evolve during implementation.